Module 3 workbook

How to Change

Modules 1 and 2 were the what. This module is the how: a practical, step by step way to change, based on resistance and repetition.

Key ideas

Neuroplasticity

The brain can change, adapt and rewire itself: neurons that fire together, wire together. London taxi drivers grew the memory area of their brains as they learnt the roads, and even imagining playing the piano changed people's wiring. There is hope for everyone.

Conscious and subconscious

Reading, classes and videos are conscious effort. Most of what we do comes from the subconscious, like the part of an iceberg under the water.

Downloading is not installing

Learning only downloads knowledge. Change happens when it is installed in the subconscious, until it becomes automatic, like brushing your teeth.

The gap causes unhappiness

When what is installed in us goes against our values, we feel that something is not right. Unhappiness is the gap between who we are and who we want to be.

Resistance and repetition

Like weight training: resist, and repeat. The old idea was 21 days to change a habit; studies suggest about 59 to 154 days. We use 30 days, because a month is easy to track. If you slip, start the 30 days again.

Uninstall and install, part by part

Mind: swap negative and suspicious thoughts for positive, reflective ones. Heart: swap pride, jealousy, anger and impatience for patience, compassion, generosity, kindness and forbearance (staying calm when others are harsh).

Reflect

What have the people closest to you said about you that you know is true, and want to change?

Which good habit did you once struggle with that is now automatic? How did you get there?

Homework: what do you want to install?

Carve out your own plan. Choose one thing to uninstall and one to install, linked to your values from Module 1 and your struggle from Module 2.

Uninstall (one bad quality)

Install (one good quality)

What triggers it?

When will I practise it?

30 days of resistance and repetition

Tick each day you manage it. If you break the chain, start again from day 1.

Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
Uninstall																														
Install																														